

Pet Emergency Action Guide

Be prepared for any pet emergency with this essential guide

Pet Name

Species/Breed

Date of Birth

Medical Conditions

Emergency Procedures

SOS

Choking



If your pet is unconscious, begin CPR immediately after clearing the airway

- ➔ Look in mouth for visible obstruction (DO NOT blindly reach in)
- ➔ For small pets: Hold upside down and give sharp pats between shoulder blades
- ➔ For large pets: Perform Heimlich maneuver (place hands just behind ribs and thrust upward)
- ➔ If unsuccessful after 2-3 attempts, rush to veterinarian
- ➔ Even if successful, have vet examine for internal injuries

Burns



- ➔ Flush with cool (not cold) running water for 5-10 minutes
- ➔ Do NOT apply ice, butter, or ointments
- ➔ Cover loosely with sterile gauze or clean cloth
- ➔ For chemical burns: Wear gloves and rinse for 15-20 minutes
- ➔ Seek veterinary care immediately for all but very minor burns

Poisoning



Never induce vomiting without professional advice - some poisons cause more damage coming back up

- ➔ Identify the poison if possible (save container/plant sample)
- ➔ Call Animal Poison Control: (888) 426-4435 (US) or local emergency number
- ➔ Follow their instructions exactly
- ➔ Do NOT give milk, salt, oil, or other home remedies
- ➔ Transport to vet with poison container if possible

Severe Bleeding



- ➔ Apply direct pressure with clean cloth or gauze for 5-10 minutes
- ➔ If blood soaks through, add more layers (do NOT remove original dressing)
- ➔ For limb wounds: Elevate above heart level if possible
- ➔ Use tourniquet ONLY as last resort for life-threatening bleeding
- ➔ Keep pet warm and transport to vet immediately

Heat Stroke



- ➔ Move to cool area immediately
- ➔ Use lukewarm (not cold) water to wet pet down gradually
- ➔ Focus on belly, groin, and paw pads
- ➔ Offer small amounts of cool water to drink
- ➔ Use fan to promote evaporation
- ➔ Stop cooling when temperature reaches 103°F (39.4°C)
- ➔ Transport to vet immediately - organ damage can occur even after cooling

Emergency Contacts

Primary Veterinarian

Clinic Name

Phone Number

Address

24-Hour Emergency Clinic

Clinic Name

Phone Number

Address

Poison Control

ASPCA Animal Poison Control: (888) 426-4435

Pet Poison Helpline: (855) 764-7661

\$75 fee may apply (worth it for life-saving advice)

Pet First Aid Kit Checklist

Keep this kit easily accessible and check expiration dates every 6 months

☐ Gauze pads & rolls

☐ Adhesive tape

☐ Antiseptic wipes

☐ Hydrogen peroxide (3%)

☐ Digital thermometer

☐ Pet-safe pain relievers

☐ Emergency blanket

☐ Muzzle (even friendly pets may bite when in pain)

☐ Styptic powder

☐ Saline eye solution

☐ Tweezers & scissors

☐ Disposable gloves

Important Information

Pet Vital Signs (Normal Range)



- ➔ **Temperature:** Dogs/Cats: 100-102.5°F (37.8-39.2°C)
- ➔ **Heart Rate:** Dogs: 60-140 bpm | Cats: 140-220 bpm
- ➔ **Respiratory Rate:** Dogs: 10-30 breaths/min | Cats: 20-30 breaths/min
- ➔ **Gum Color:** Should be pink (press to check capillary refill - should return to pink in <2 sec)

Transporting an Injured Pet



- ➔ Muzzle injured pet if possible (even gentle animals may bite when in pain)
- ➔ Stabilize injuries before moving (use makeshift splints if needed)
- ➔ For small pets: Use rigid carrier or box with towel lining
- ➔ For large pets: Use blanket as stretcher (have someone help lift)
- ➔ Call vet en route so they can prepare for your arrival

Print this guide and keep with your pet supplies | Review emergency procedures regularly
Consider taking a pet first aid/CPR course from the Red Cross or local animal organization